

First Week Home Checklist

For: Dog — Day-by-day settle-in tasks so the first week feels calm instead of chaotic.

Pet's name: _____

Date home: _____

BEFORE THEY ARRIVE

- ☐ Set up a crate or designated sleep space in a quiet corner
- ☐ Pick up food and water bowls and place them in one steady spot
- ☐ Buy a few days of their current food to avoid a sudden diet change
- ☐ Set a house rule list with everyone in the household (furniture, feeding, doors)

DAY 1

- ☐ Keep the first car ride and arrival calm and low-key
- ☐ Show them the water bowl and a quiet resting spot right away
- ☐ Take them out to the same potty spot often, and praise calmly when they go
- ☐ Skip the welcome party — let visitors wait a few days

DAYS 2–3

- ☐ Start a simple feeding and potty schedule and stick to it
- ☐ Begin short, positive name and hand-target training sessions
- ☐ Note any sniffing, hiding, or clinginess — settling in looks different for every dog

DAYS 4–7

- ☐ Introduce one new person or short outing at a time
- ☐ Book their first vet visit if it isn't already scheduled
- ☐ Start loose-leash walks in a quiet area before busier streets
- ☐ Begin crate or alone-time practice in very short sessions